

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX

Index No.:
Date Purchased: 8/5/21

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CAREN BAEZ,

SUMMONS

Plaintiff,

-against-

Plaintiff designates
BRONX County as the
place of trial

CITY OF NEW YORK, P.O. EDUARD LUCERO,
P.O. JOHN ELLER, P.O. MATTHEW BARLOW,
P.O. FELIX PICHARDO, Lt. ROMAIN WILSON and
POLICE OFFICERS JOHN AND JAMES DOE, meant to
designate offending officers, each Individually and in
their official capacities,

The basis of venue is:
CPLR 504 (3)

Defendants.
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To the above named Defendants:

You are hereby summoned to answer the complaint in this action, and
serve a copy of your answer, or, if the complaint is not served with this summons, to
serve a notice of appearance on the Plaintiff's attorneys within twenty days after the
service of this summons, exclusive of the day of service, where service is made by
delivery upon you personally within the state, or within 30 days after completion of
service where service is made in any other manner. In case of your failure to appear or
answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the
complaint to be assessed by the Court.

Dated: Bronx, N.Y.

August 5, 2021



By: **JONATHAN L. GLEIT, ESQ.**
Attorney for Plaintiff

888 Grand Concourse
Suite 1-O
Bronx, NY 10451
(718) 742-0200

To: CITY OF NEW YORK CORPORATION COUNSEL
100 Church Street, New York, New York 10007

P.O. EDUARD LUCERO Tax Reg No. 960838, P.O. JOHN ELLER Tax Reg No. 965069, P.O. MATTHEW
BARLOW Tax Reg No. 9649910, P.O. FELIX PICHARDO Tax Reg No. 957956 Lt. ROMAIN WILSON Tax
Reg No. 949804 all of the 40th Precinct 257 Alexander Ave., Bronx NY 10454

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX

-----X
CAREN BAEZ,

Index No.:

Plaintiff,

VERIFIED COMPLAINT

-against-

CITY OF NEW YORK, P.O. EDUARD LUCERO,
P.O. JOHN ELLER, P.O. MATTHEW BARLOW,
P.O. FELIX PICHARDO, Lt. ROMAIN WILSON and
POLICE OFFICERS JOHN AND JAMES DOE, meant to
designate offending officers, each Individually and in
their official capacities,

Defendants.

-----X

Plaintiff, by her attorney, Jonathan L. Gleit, Esq., complaining of the Defendants,
respectfully alleges, upon information and belief, as follows:

AS AND FOR A FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF THE
PLAINTIFF CAREN BAEZ

1. At the time of the commencement of this action, plaintiff CAREN BAEZ was and
still is a resident of the County of Bronx, City and State of New York.
2. That the causes of action alleged herein arose in the County of Bronx, City and
State of New York.
3. That at all times herein mentioned, Defendants CITY OF NEW YORK was, and
still is, a Municipal Corporation and body politic, duly formed, organized and existing
under and by virtue of the laws of the State of New York.

4. That the CITY OF NEW YORK maintains a Police Department.
5. That on and about May 25, 2020 P.O. EDUARD LUCERO was employed by the CITY OF NEW YORK and THE NEW YORK POLICE DEPARTMENT.
6. That on and about May 25, 2020, at approximately 9 P.M., P.O. EDUARD LUCERO was working and acting within the scope of his employment as a Police Officer, and under the color of law.
7. That on and about May 25, 2020 P.O. JOHN ELLER was employed by the CITY OF NEW YORK and THE NEW YORK POLICE DEPARTMENT.
8. That on and about May 25, 2020, at approximately 9 P.M., P.O. JOHN ELLER was working and acting within the scope of his employment as a Police Officer, and under the color of law.
9. That on and about May 25, 2020 P.O. MATTHEW BARLOW was employed by the CITY OF NEW YORK and THE NEW YORK POLICE DEPARTMENT.
10. That on and about May 25, 2020, at approximately 9 P.M., P.O. MATTHEW BARLOW was working and acting within the scope of his employment as a Police Officer, and under the color of law.
11. That on and about May 25, 2020 P.O. FELIX PICHARDO was employed by the CITY OF NEW YORK and THE NEW YORK POLICE DEPARTMENT.

12. That on and about May 25, 2020, at approximately 9 P.M., P.O. FELIX

PICHARDO was working and acting within the scope of his employment as a Police Officer, and under the color of law.

13. That on and about May 25, 2020 Lt. ROMAIN WILSON was employed by the CITY OF NEW YORK and THE NEW YORK POLICE DEPARTMENT.

14. That on and about May 25, 2020, at approximately 9 P.M., Lt. ROMAIN WILSON was working and acting within the scope of his employment as a Police Officer, and under the color of law.

15. That on and about May 25, 2020, OFFICERS JOHN AND/OR JAMES DOE, as hereinafter referred to, were employed by the CITY OF NEW YORK and THE NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT.

16. That on and about May 25, 2020, at approximately 9 P.M., said OFFICERS JOHN AND/OR JAMES DOE were working and acting within the scope of their employment as a Police Officers, and under the color of law.

17. That on or about May 25, 2020 at approximately approximately 9 P.M., plaintiff was lawfully present at or near the vicinity of 600 Concord Avenue, Bronx, New York.

18. That near the above time and approximate place plaintiff became aware that an individual, a minor, known to her, was being forcefully assaulted by police officers.

19. Plaintiff, who had recently turned 18 years of age, was approximately five foot two inches tall and weighted approximately 100 pounds, went to retrieve a piece of personal property near the assaulting officers.

20. Without warning, P.O. EDUARD LUCERO did violently assault plaintiff, lifted her and threw her to the ground and punched plaintiff before pressing his weight upon her and restraining plaintiff with handcuffs.

21. That offending officer did utilize unnecessary unjustified excessive force upon plaintiff, which constituted an assault and battery upon plaintiff.

22. That on or about May 25, 2020 at approximately approximately 9 P.M., at or near the vicinity of 600 Concord Avenue Avenue, Bronx, New York, the plaintiff CAREN BAEZ was assaulted and improperly arrested and confined without privilege, warrant, proper authority nor justification, having no reason in law or in fact to assault, arrest or confine CAREN BAEZ.

23. That the defendants, their agents, servants and/or employees arrested the plaintiff CAREN BAEZ without any basis in law or fact and without reasonable, probable or just cause or justification.

24. That the defendants, their agents, servants and/or employees arrested the plaintiff CAREN BAEZ without any basis in law or fact, by making false accusations

against her, when they knew, or in the exercise of reasonable care, should have known they were false.

25. That the defendants, their agents, servants and/or employees unlawfully arrested, searched and detained the plaintiff CAREN BAEZ, who was aware of his unlawful detention and confinement, and took his property without any basis in law or fact, thereby causing fright, shock, emotional distress and physical consequences.

26. That plaintiff was forcibly detained, including being restrained by hand cuffs and by other means, which necessarily constituted additional unwanted touching, thereby further assaulting and battering plaintiff.

27. That plaintiff was transported to the 40th Police Precinct where she was placed in a jail cell and ultimately was released from the precinct at approximately 5 AM on May 26, 2020.

28. That the defendants P.O. EDUARD LUCERO, P.O. JOHN ELLER, P.O. MATTHEW BARLOW, P.O. FELIX PICHARDO, Lt. ROMAIN WILSON and OFFICERS JOHN AND JAMES DOE, did knowingly and maliciously provide or allow to be provided, false information to the prosecutor of the criminal action against plaintiff thereby initiating and causing her to suffer an unjust prosecution that defendants had no reasonable expectation would succeed.

29. Thereafter, plaintiff was required to appear in the Criminal Court of the City of New York, to defend again the unjust charges of Assault, Obstructing Governmental Administration and Harassment under Case Number CR-102970-20BX, which were ultimately dismissed on June 9, 2021 by the Hon. Erik L. Gray, a Judge of the Criminal Court and the prosecution was terminated in Plaintiff's favor

30. As a result, Plaintiff suffered a malicious prosecution.

31. That the CITY OF NEW YORK and the named defendants did falsely and wrongfully arrest plaintiff without probable or reasonable cause nor knowledge of warrant, intended to and did confine plaintiff without her consent, which non-privileged confinement plaintiff was consciously aware of and did initiate a criminal proceeding without probable cause maliciously.

32. That the CITY OF NEW YORK allowed, condoned, permitted and caused a policy and procedure of repeatedly arresting innocent citizens, and engaging in a policy and procedure of arresting persons without individualized reasonable or probable cause for nefarious, unlawful reasons, including to satisfy arrest quotas, to obtain overtime pay and/or for employment advancement and/or to attempt to justify their own wrongful conduct, and without probable or reasonable cause, and repeatedly providing false information and testimony without reprimand to the offending officers.

33. That said illegal and unlawful arrests of innocent persons without reasonable or probable cause and conducting searches in public and while in custody are a matter of policy and record and openly acknowledged or known by the defendants and their supervisors, yet condoned without any reprimand of the offending officers, referral to the District Attorney or Federal Law Enforcement officials for criminal prosecution, or even bone fide internal investigation to deter actions like those complained of herein and evidenced by the large amount of dismissals of criminal charges under similar circumstances.

34. Said policy, practice and procedure of having arrest quotas and/or productivity goals which results in the false arrests of innocent persons is exhibited, for instance, in the November 1, 2011 conviction of New York Police Department Det. Jason Arbeeny, whereat Justice Gustin Reichbach commented on the evidence presented by several witnesses that officers were expected to make certain arrest goals.

35. Additionally in the case of Floyd, et al. v. City of New York, et al., In the Southern District of New York Case 08 Civ.1034, New York City Police Officer Adhil Polanco testified in open court and under oath that the NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT routinely arrest primarily minority populations without a legal reason to do so, and are required or expected to do so, to satisfy arrest quotas. Said arrest

quotas, euphemistically known under such terms as 'productivity goals', lead to a practice and procedure of, for instance, arresting persons for conduct that is not criminal.

36. Additionally, Officer Craig Matthews presented evidence in federal court that he was subject to retaliation for reporting said quota system in 2009 and Officers Pedro Serrano and Adrain Schoolcraft presented evidence in recorded form of the use of arrest quotas by the New York City Police Department..

37. Furthermore the CITY OF NEW YORK allowed, condoned, permitted and caused a policy and procedure of arresting innocent persons for such charges as disorderly conduct in ill-fated attempts at justifying their own misconduct, or in retaliation for legal behaviors not to the arresting officers liking, and in an effort to subjugate certain minority male populations as an excuse for selectively enforcing supposed 'quality of life' violations.

38. Said practice and procedure of falsely arresting innocent persons on such charges as Obstruction of Governmental Administration is well evidence by defendants' own compstat and other statistical tabulations, as well as those of the district attorney, the civilian complaint review board and the bureau of internal affairs in retaliation and in ill-fated attempts at justifying their own wrongful conduct.

39. For instance, statistical analysis of the 51,503 criminal cases in New York City from 2009 through 2014 charging resisting arrest show that 5% of officers account for 40% of resisting arrest charges and 15% of officers account for nearly 75% of such cases and 60% of officers made arrests while never charging resisting arrest, evincing, among other things, the violent nature of only certain officers, including the named offers herein.

40. Additionally on October 1, 2015 the New York City Department of Investigation Office of the Inspector General for the NYPD issued a report, which is incorporated herein and can be found at http://www.nyc.gov/html/oignypd/assets/downloads/pdf/oig_nypd_use_of_force_report_-_oct_1_2015.pdf. That report determined that the New York City Police Department routinely fails to discipline officers who have engaged in misconduct, and fails to adequately track instances of abuse of power, and fails to properly train officers, and despite those findings, and perfunctory attempts at remediation, the practice continues unabated, and was evidenced by the The Report of the Independent Panel on the Disciplinary System of the New York City Police Department, found at <https://www.independentpanelreportnypd.net> and incorporated herein

41. While numerous high profile cases demonstrate this practice, such as the de minimis discipline of the police officers who caused or contributed to the deaths of Eric Gardner and Noel Polanco or the assault upon James Blake, thousands of other individuals have been victims of this practice, including the Plaintiff herein, who garner no publicity but who are necessarily known by the Defendants by virtue of the claims and actions brought and filed against such officers who engage in such nefarious and brutal actions yet receive little or no repercussions or discipline as detailed above.

42. Furthermore, a recent report and analysis conducted by the New York City Civilian Complaint Review Board, found at https://www1.nyc.gov/assets/ccrb/downloads/pdf/policy_pdf/issue_based/CCRB_YouthReport.pdf and respectfully incorporated herein, found that 64% of civilian complaints against New York City police officers were filed by or on behalf of young people of color ages 8 to 18 who claimed to have been mistreated after being stopped for innocuous activities. The Board analyzed 112 completed investigations between Jan. 1, 2018 and June 30, 2019, showing an overwhelming number (nearly 90%) of grievances involved children of color (black and Hispanic youth). The report also found that the number of complaints by youth of color was significantly larger than in the overall population (69.1%).

43. Among the complaints probed was [A] a March 2018 incident in which a group of black and Hispanic boys was stopped by multiple police officers simply for talking, laughing and playing with sticks picked up off the ground as they walked home, according to the report. A lieutenant had two of the boys, an 8-year-old and a 14-year-old, whom officers saw running with sticks in their hands handcuffed and taken to a police station in tears, according to the report; [B] An 11-year-old black boy who was stopped and frisked by an undercover officer after they saw him shaking hands with and high-fiving a group of adults he knew in a housing project; [C] A 16-year-old Hispanic boy stopped for jaywalking by an officer and a sergeant in plainclothes and searched without probable cause, according to the report. [D] A 15-year-old black boy was holding a deli bag and walking to a homeless shelter when a plainclothes detective and sergeant in an unmarked vehicle ordered him to stop without announcing they were police. The teenager ran but was tackled and handcuffed, suffering injuries.

44. That no negligence or actions on the part of the plaintiff CAREN BAEZ contributed to the occurrences alleged herein in any manner whatsoever.

45. That this cause of action falls within one or more of the exceptions as set forth in CPLR Section 1602.

46. That as a result of the foregoing, the plaintiff CAREN BAEZ was damaged in a sum which exceeds the jurisdiction of all lower Courts.

AS AND FOR A SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF THE

PLAINTIFF CAREN BAEZ

47. That plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs enumerated 1 through 46 as though more fully set forth herein.

48. That on July 23, 2020 plaintiff caused a Notice of Claim to be presented to the defendant CITY OF NEW YORK, by providing a copy thereof to the offices of the defendant CITY OF NEW YORK, which said Notice of Claim set forth the name and post office address of the claimant and claimant's attorney, the nature of the claim, the time when, the place where, and the manner in which the claim arose and items of damage or injuries claimed to have been sustained, so far as then practicable.

49. At least thirty (30) days have elapse prior to the commencement of this action and adjustment of payment thereof be neglected or refused by the defendant.

50. Defendant did notice and demand a General Municipal Law §50-h hearing and plaintiff did appear and testify at said hearing on January 4, 2021.

51. This action was commenced on the claim within one year and ninety days after the happening of the events upon which the claims are based or within the time allowed by law.

52. That on or about May 25, 2020 at approximately 9 P.M., at or near the vicinity of 600 Concord Avenue, Bronx, New York, the plaintiff CAREN BAEZ was improperly

arrested and confined without privilege, knowledge of warrant, proper authority, justification nor reasonable or probable cause, having no reason in law or in fact to arrest CAREN BAEZ.

53. That at all times herein mentioned, Defendants, their agents, servants and / or employees, deprived the plaintiff CAREN BAEZ of Due Process under Law.

54. That the acts of the Defendants, CITY OF NEW YORK, their agents, servants and / or employees, P.O. EDUARD LUCERO, P.O. JOHN ELLER, P.O. MATTHEW BARLOW, P.O. FELIX PICHARDO, Lt. ROMAIN WILSON and POLICE OFFICERS JOHN AND/OR JAMES DOE were acts of discrimination, were racist, and improper, and that the defendants' actions amounted to False Arrest, and the defendants were otherwise careless, reckless and negligent.

55. That the plaintiff CAREN BAEZ, being aware of her unjust confinement, suffered severe and serious physical, emotional and psychological trauma, damages and injuries due to the negligence, carelessness and recklessness of Defendants CITY OF NEW YORK and it POLICE OFFICERS JOHN AND/OR JAMES DOE.

56. That no negligence or actions on the part of the plaintiff CAREN BAEZ contributed to the occurrences alleged herein in any manner whatsoever.

57. That this cause of action falls within one or more of the exceptions as set forth in CPLR Section 1602.

58. That as a result of the foregoing, the plaintiff CAREN BAEZ was damaged in a sum which exceeds the jurisdiction of all lower Courts.

AS AND FOR A THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF THE

PLAINTIFF CAREN BAEZ

59. That plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs enumerated 1 through 58 as though more fully set forth herein.

60. That during his aforesaid arrest, the defendants, their agents, servants and/or employees utilized unnecessary, excessive and unjustified force against the plaintiff.

61. That the actions herein described, by the defendants, their agents, servants and/or employees, constituted assaults and battery upon Plaintiff.

62. As a result of the aforesaid assaults, plaintiff CAREN BAEZ received injuries with accompanying physical and mental pain and suffering; that the plaintiff was made, still is and will continue to be sick, sore, lame and disabled and sustained other injuries, both internal and external; that it was necessary and will be so in the future, to incur medical expenses for the care, treatment and attention of the plaintiff and for the purchase of drugs and medicines, and that plaintiff was and in the future will be

prevented from attending to plaintiff's usual vocation and avocations and was otherwise damaged and injured.

63. That no negligence or actions on the part of the plaintiff contributed to the occurrences alleged herein in any manner whatsoever.

64. That this cause of action falls within one or more of the exceptions as set forth in CPLR Section 1602.

65. That as a result of the foregoing, the plaintiff CAREN BAEZ was damaged in a sum which exceeds the jurisdiction of all lower Courts.

AS AND FOR A FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF THE

PLAINTIFF CAREN BAEZ

66. That plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs enumerated 1 through 65 as though more fully set forth herein.

67. That on July 23, 2020 plaintiff caused a Notice of Claim to be presented to the defendant CITY OF NEW YORK, by providing a copy thereof to the offices of the defendant CITY OF NEW YORK, which said Notice of Claim set forth the name and post office address of the claimant and claimant's attorney, the nature of the claim, the time when, the place where, and the manner in which the claim arose and items of damage or injuries claimed to have been sustained, so far as then practicable.

68. At least thirty (30) days have elapse prior to the commencement of this action and adjustment of payment thereof be neglected or refused by the defendant.

69. Defendant did not notice and demand a General Municipal Law §50-h hearing although plaintiff did appear and testify at a hearing on January 4, 2021 on the underlying claim as noted above.

79. This action was commenced on the claim within one year and ninety days after the happening of the events upon which the claims are based or within the time allowed by law.

71. That the defendants P.O. EDUARD LUCERO, P.O. JOHN ELLER, P.O. MATTHEW BARLOW, P.O. FELIX PICHARDO, Lt. ROMAIN WILSON and OFFICERS JOHN AND JAMES DOE, did knowingly and maliciously provide or allow to be provided, false information to the prosecutor of the criminal action against plaintiff thereby initiating and causing her to suffer an unjust prosecution that defendants had no reasonable expectation would succeed.

72. Thereafter, plaintiff was required to appear in the Criminal Court of the City of New York, to defend again the unjust charges of Assault, Obstructing Governmental Administration and Harassment under Case Number CR-102970-20BX, which were

ultimately dismissed on June 9, 2021 by the Hon. Erik L. Gray, a Judge of the Criminal Court and the prosecution was terminated in Plaintiff's favor

73. As a result, Plaintiff suffered a malicious prosecution.

74. As a result of the malicious prosecution, plaintiff's liberty was threatened for a period of approximately three hundred and eighty days and suffered the humiliation, mental anguish, indignity and frustration of an unjust criminal prosecution, and was otherwise damaged and injured.

75. That this cause of action falls within one or more of the exceptions as set forth in CPLR Section 1602.

76. That as a result of the foregoing, the Plaintiff CAREN BAEZ was damaged in a sum which exceeds the jurisdiction of all lower Courts.

AS AND FOR A FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF THE

PLAINTIFF CAREN BAEZ

77. That plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs enumerated 1 through 76 as though more fully set forth herein.

78. That the defendants carelessly, recklessly and negligently failed to properly interview, hire, select, train, manage, supervise and control its employees, agents, and / or servants and negligently retained its employees, agents, and / or servants.

79. That the defendants carelessly, recklessly and negligently failed to properly interview, hire, select, train, manage, supervise and control its employees, agents, and / or servants and negligently retained its employees, agents, and / or servants in the proper and lawful arrest of individuals and in the proper use of force.
80. That solely by reason of the aforesaid occurrence, and as a direct and proximate result of the Defendant's negligence, plaintiff CAREN BAEZ was denied freedom and rights under the federal and state constitutions and received great and severe injuries with accompanying physical and mental pain and suffering; that the plaintiff was made, and still are and will continue to be sick, sore, lame and disabled and sustained other injuries, both internal and external, all of which, upon information and belief, will be permanent; that it was necessary and will be so in the future, to incur medical expenses for the care, treatment and attention of the plaintiff and for the purchase of drugs and medicines, and that plaintiff was and in the future will be prevented from attending to plaintiff's usual vocation and avocations; all to the plaintiff's damage in sums which exceed the jurisdiction of all lower Courts.
81. That this cause of action falls within one or more of the exceptions as set forth in CPLR Section 1602.

WHEREFORE, Plaintiff demands judgment against the Defendants on the First Second, Third, Fourth and Fifth Causes of Action, and inclusive of punitive damages, and attorneys fees as permitted by statute, in sums which exceed the jurisdiction of all lower Courts, together with the costs and disbursements of this action.

Dated: Bronx, N.Y.
August 5, 2021



By: JONATHAN L. GLEIT, ESQ.
Attorney for Plaintiff
CAREN BAEZ
888 Grand Concourse
Suite 1-O
Bronx, NY 10451
(718) 742-0200

To:

CITY OF NEW YORK
CORPORATION COUNSEL
4th Floor, Law Dept.
New York, New York 10007

ATTORNEY'S VERIFICATION

Jonathan L. Gleit, an attorney duly admitted to practice before the Courts of the State of New York, affirms the following to be true under the penalties of perjury:

I am the attorney of record for Plaintiff,

CAREN BAEZ

I have read the annexed

COMPLAINT

and know the contents thereof, and the same are true to my knowledge, except those matters therein which are stated to be alleged upon information and belief, and as to those matters I believe them to be true. My belief, as to those matters therein not stated upon knowledge, is based upon facts, records, and other pertinent information contained in my files.

The reason this verification is made by myself and not Plaintiff is that Plaintiff is not presently present in the county where your affirmant maintains his office.

DATED: Bronx, N.Y.

August 5, 2021



JONATHAN L. GLEIT, ESQ.